

Sankofa Couriers: CarPlay Activity Reconstruction (Case SANKOFA-CP-2025-0042)

Courier Daniel Owusu drives CarPlay-equipped vans for a parcel-delivery firm in the Accra–Tema area. During a routine fleet review (Feb–Apr 2025), his iPhone was acquired as a full file system extraction.

The task: reconstruct how he used his phone in the vehicle, which cars it paired to, when CarPlay connected and disconnected, what he did during each drive (navigate, message, call, play music, use Siri), and where he was and judge whether he interacted hands-free through the car or physically handled the phone.

No crime, just a reconstruction exercise. Everything is synthetic.

Beginner — identification and orientation

1. Establish the device identity: make, model, iOS version, owner name, and the device's own phone number. Which single file tells the examiner this is an iPhone rather than a generic file dump?
2. How many contacts are stored on the device, what numbering convention do the numbers follow, and which number belongs to the device owner rather than a contact?
3. How many CarPlay-capable vehicles was this phone paired with? Name each one and state whether it connected over USB or wirelessly.
4. Where are CarPlay pairings stored on an iPhone? For each paired vehicle, report the vehicle name, the CarPlay unit/accessory ID, and the Bluetooth MAC address.
5. What music application was used in the vehicle, and name three specific tracks that were played through CarPlay.

Intermediate — reconstruction and correlation

6. How many CarPlay connection sessions are recorded over the examined period? Identify the longest session, including the vehicle and its start and end times.
7. Using knowledgeC /app/inFocus and /app/usage, which applications were most frequently active during CarPlay sessions?
8. Pick one drive and build its timeline end to end: vehicle connected, which apps came into focus, what music played, any Siri use, and disconnect.
9. Identify the dictation events. When did the user invoke Siri while connected to CarPlay, and which trigger was used, the CarPlay Siri button or the steering-wheel control?
10. Using the location database and photo GPS, determine roughly where the phone was during a chosen session, and corroborate the two sources against each other.

Advanced — analysis and interpretation

11. Distinguish phone-screen use from CarPlay-screen use. Correlate lock state, display backlight, `App.InFocus`, Siri events, and audio route to argue whether the user physically handled the phone or interacted through the car display. State the limits of your conclusion.
12. Which of the active contacts did the user message or call *while a CarPlay session was live*? Correlate message and call timestamps against the session windows.
13. Determine which vehicle used wired CarPlay and which used wireless, name the artifacts that support each finding, and explain why that distinction matters for what evidence you would expect to find.
14. Perform an audio-routing analysis: demonstrate that output was routed to the vehicle (`CarAudio`) and that the microphone was engaged (`CarMicrophone`) during dictation. What does this prove, and importantly, what does it not prove, about driver distraction?
15. Cross-source validation: take a single claim for example, "the user navigated toward Tema Port while connected to CarPlay" and corroborate it across at least three independent artifacts (`knowledgeC`, Apple/Google Maps history, the location database, photo GPS). Identify any gaps or contradictions, and explain how you would caveat the finding in a report.

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